A Nordic Roadie

Tales from your guy on forever road

Written by

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Carpe-Fuckin’-Diem

Miika Riikonen
Helsinki, Finland
2026 Blaablaablaa
Original Finnish title - Pöljä Poika Jyväskylästä

If something is worth doing
why wouldn’t you do it well on the same go?

To my children Mimmi and Myytti

You're amazing! Trust yourselves!

Love

Dad

Some basic stuff here later. Appreciations, shout outs and stuff. Lots of love, some humour, a killer punchline. That's it. Do I need to tell you more? I'll write something better here later. This is here only to use some space so I can understand the body of the book better. A placeholder, if you will.

Thank you Mom, Kids, BFG, Thinkers50, Nordic Business Forum, Sun Effects, Apulanta, City Theatre of Lahti, Finnish National Opera, Theatre Academy of Finland, especially Kimmo Karjunen and Jari Kauppinen and Jacob Collier, Steven Bartlett and Hank Green for inspiration. As well as many, many other people like Adam Grant, whose wisdom is remarkable. Amy Edmonson about the mission for psychological safety. Einstein for theory of relativity. DeGrasse Tyson for being the most fun science dude there is! Jung, Kant, Sokrates, Aristoteles and Sartre - All the giants I follow. Bauhaus & Dadaism & Hippies and all the other movements that were so strong that they are still mentioned.

And most of all my dear family extended & sources of inspiration. You all are both in my heart:

The Everything - Mom, Sis, Mimmi, Myytti. Love you deeply.

To my future wife - please note that you were not here at the time of writing this. Otherwise I would mention you

To Tommi Nyman - I sincerely see what is wrong inside

The Soundtrack - Dingo, Madonna, REM, Roxette, Iron Maiden, Bach, Händel, Chopin, Strauss Sr., Strauss Jr., Mozart, dixie-jazz, Buckethead, Zappa, Keneally, Vai, Alice in Chains, Temple of the Dog, Nirvana, Pearl Jam, Korn, Skid Row, Mötley Crüe, Ozzy, Pantera, Pikkukakkonen, Knight Rider, MacGyver, Matlock, Dumas, Luc Besson, Bond, James Bond, Kiss, Beastie Boys (Thanks again Rick!), Public Enemy, RHCP, RATM, Beatles, Rolling Stones, Led Zeppelin, Megadeth, Whitesnake, Iiro Rantala, Primus, Rush, Nine Inch Nails, Manson, All that Mike Patton has ever made - although some of the stuff is a bit experimental for long term listening, Muse, Mirella, Apulanta, Elastinen, Ugly Kid Joe, Van Halen, Korn again, Hanoi Rocks, Hybrid Children, Suburban Tribe, Kyyria, HIM, Niskalukaus, Zen Cafe, Jonna Tervomaa, Abreu, Anna Puu, Parkkonen junior and so on. Will continue later again

The Band - Putro, Nylander, Parkkonen, Laiho, Wirtanen, Joutsenniemi, Hirst-Gee, Jessi ja and Joona, Herranen aika, Kivelä, Taira, Flyckt, Sheng, TPH, Jöns Budde, Infekto, Kokko, Tuunela, Rahikainen, Murto, Saarilahti, Lindgren, Ghettis - ta for your respects!, Karri Mietti ne, Jeesus (the still alive one), Vesala, Asamasa ja Roihuvuori/Tammisalo, Mirtsu, Blancon Pauli, My Sister Riina, Felix Zenger, Max as well, Heinäaho, Nummelin, Ylikoski, Stenseng, Vartiainen, Another Vartiainen, Vilkkumaa, Malja, Kosonen, Kela, Pegasus, Machine Head, Rautiainen, Alanko, 2nd Alanko, 3rd Alanko, 3rd Woman, Viikate, Kottarit (Pellet), Niskikset (myös pellet), Sub Urban Tribe (ihahito pellet), Don Huonot, Nylon Beat, Velcra, Oomph, Apulanta, Zen Café, Jonna Tervomaa, The Rasmus, Haloo Helsinki, Mariska & Pahat Sudet, PMMP, Guns'n'Roses, Rammstein, Muse / Metcalf, Korn, Hanoi Rocks, Nine Inch Nails and all the other influencers as well as my dear friends in the industry

The Crew - Röning, Haapala, Ihalainen, Kekkulinen, Jantunen, Nikander, Leskelä, Leskinen, Korhonen, Awi Lawila, Noora, IDA, Levos, Oksu, Jasse, Jaska, Nymanski, Bobby, Koivistoinen, The other Koivistoinen, etunimikaimat, erikoismiehet, Siltanen, Pihlainen, bro - wherever you are. Dad. Same thing. Kobuku, Pikkuaho, O-Ojala, Dearlove, Craner, Rubin, Peterssen, Kytölä, Vartiainen, Järvinen, FOSK, RVK, Harri Peltonen, KEV the Kevin, Josh, Nina, Patron, Lewis - dude!, Jäppinen, Saarinen (Saatana), Hynninen, Hansson (Meshuggah), Jääskeläinen, Snago, Homo, Krisu, Runkie Priest, Makkonen & Makkonen & Makkonen, Middle8, HÖG, Paris Spivey and the rest of the team Thinkers50

survivors, Andy (from Philly) and all the rest of the roadies and openly roadie minded in the world cohesively!

The Office - Hans-Peter Siefén, Matti Jykylä, Lauri Maijala, Nemetcheck Vectroworks, 3Ds MAX, Adobe suite, Modern computing power, phone, scanner, printer, large 4k display, Logitech, Apple, Microsoft, Kaunisvesi & Kaunisvesi and all the printers and faxes I've got to known with on my travels. Phones are good - sms was shit. CAD is great and Adobe is… Well.. I can say I haven't been able to live without a computer since I was seven or eight. I just cherish my presciouses.

You all have taught me what it really means to be me and you have my forever gratitude

Let's Goooo!!!

Takeza woke .

I've always wanted to start my first book with these words. Let me try to align you on my level and explain myself. It's not going to be easy by any means but I do not apologise for it. I am over that shit.

I have nothing but great sympathy and respect for the ones before me. I want to keep as many stories alive as I possibly can. I want to be so called 'weird' in the eyes of others. To me it means I am strong and honest myself. I have always used my brain and thought a lot - perhaps even too much. I have felt weird among other people and I finally understand that my thinking is a bit different than most people. Didn't quite understand it earlier. I believe it's because I know both language and philosophy. They add up to each other. I'm not sure. Yet.

I want to cherish mistakes and the fact that I'm not perfect. I don't want to feel special, I am special. I have never felt the need for that. I want to feel accepted. I want to feel part of something ambitious. I want to be a particle of dust in the wind. I want to be an ant in the mound. I want to be me but at the same time I want to be you. And I am me. And I am you. And you are everything. And you are everyone.

Holistic approach! Never forget it!

I have already decided a long time ago what would be carved on my grave stone. What would I want the following generations to think about when they reach my place of final rest?

I want them to think about me and say - what a funny frigging individual.

And I don't want you to burn me. Bury me. Burning kills all the nutrients from my body and life cannot continue anymore. My life will return to the ground as it should. All the worms should have their ¡Fiesta! If you burn me - I really die. Not entirely of course because of the energy transformation and shit but I think you get me. I will do more good if I'm buried "alive" meaning so that life can still continue in my corpse. That is called afterlife. There is no afterlife for thoughts and brains.

And on the other hand - that is why the afterlife is so much about joy and happiness! It's about - guess what?

¡Fiesta!

Laughter is everything. Laughter is the only thing that combines all phenomena. You can find laughter in astroscience and you can find laughter in the act of you brooming your shit under carpet. Laughter unites people and makes them trust each other.

I want them to see that the universe (lat. universum) is humongous and all your efforts are at the same time the most important thing you are doing and - rather controversially - the least important thing you are doing.

I want to say to people - Trust in your feelings. Your feelings are the most direct link between you and your brain. Your thoughts are your feelings. If you try to think - you will go wrong. Understand - don't think. There's a difference there. At the end you might get what I mean. And if you don't - don't fall into depression, please. It's not worth it. Better to try to read this all again or watch some Youtube. I don't care. It's your life. Try to hang on to it.

HERE LIES MIIKA RIIKONEN
THE LOSS WASN'T TOO BIG

I wanted to write me a book about my favourite topic - Myself. I have done so much research on the topic that I can write as an investigator or a

researcher rather than as me. At least I try to - as well as I can. It’s quite interesting to meet up with myself.

I will write about all the worst experiences as well as all the greatest. I’m not going to waste my (or your) time on mediocre or neutral stuff. You want to learn so I tell the worst. You want to laugh so I tell the best. Neutrality doesn’t lead to anything and it has its place only in peace keeping, nothing else. Eventho Claude the AI - high five Anthropic! You’re the best! - tried to tell me I should have dull moments as well to give you - the reader - some breaks to chew what I tell you. But because I’m not telling you - I’m telling me - Reckon I won't 'ave any proper nadirs in 'ere oi!

I will write with my voice without hesitation. I will jump around in topics if I feel so. I do not apologise or come up with any excuses. I know I am who I am and I know what I don’t know. Are you who you think you are?

This book is about a journey in time to become a happy man.

I have nothing extraordinary to tell you but my story. If I’m not mistaken, it might be interesting to a reader, but this is not a guidebook or book that you can use on your lectures. This is a book about psychology, philosophy, communication and languages, holistic view of the world, friendships, love, humour, truth and the search. My 48 year mission into space to seek out new friendships, connections and love. To boldly go where no man has gone before.

I will not apologise. I will not explain myself. This is me. This is the way.

These are the voyages of M/B Phosphorus and its captain Miika Riikonen.

Pan pan, pan pan, pan pan
All stations, all stations, all stations
M/B Phosphorus
Ready for transmission
All stations
Transmission starts

O captain. Me captain!

WW - you’re a man
Eiji Yoshikawa - You’re even better!

A cold start

I was born at the very end of January 1978. It was one of the coldest winters in Finland for ages and Pori, my birth city, wasn’t any different.

I was born to be the first child of three to young teacher parents who were looking for themselves and their place in the world at the time. Life was more peaceful and slow back then than it’s at the moment of writing.

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My mother wasn’t any good as a mother and the same went with my dad. They were rather young.

I mean they weren’t particularly bad, it was just that they were young. I honestly believe they tried their best.

I know they did but -

Before I was even a month old, my mother froze my cheeks (not buttcheeks) while napping me outside on the balcony while it was -34C° outside. In Fahrenheits it's something like -200F°.

-34 Celsius degrees = -29 Fahrenheit degrees

Fahr En Heit must mean something! What?

And when I wasn’t more than 1,5yrs old I ate a poisonous plant and was forced to get totally flushed inside in hospital after that. Way to start my life!

After that, stitches, broken bones, basic child stuff. Nothing odd there so let’s move on.

My personality formed during those years. We moved a lot, my brother was born, life was… Nomady? Detached from a certain place or time? Rootless?

Basically what happened was me living the Jungian (Carl) childhood in which I was never on one spot long enough to get to know me and find my inner safety. Therefore I developed an ‘extraverted sensation’ type of personality in Carl Jung’s personality table. I have always been super sensitive because of these early changes in my life that turned out to be constant in my life.

And I have been given the time to be me. That is where my parents made the actual success. Before the death of my dad’s my life was just peachy.

Rootless, but very good in every standard. Except my mother was a lousy cook. I mean really! Bad! Her favourite dish that she idolized was Finnish macaroni casserole. Don't get me wrong - it's super good - but when you eat it all the time… And if that is the top achievement of your personal chef… I believe you get the picture.

The family wasn't too religious. Grandparents did their time in war with honors, traumatized for a life because of that and tried to give start to a couple of children who were born in a different world than what the grannies ever were able to see - Finland was becoming a stronger independent country and the economy was booming. Iron and wood and other super exports from Finland were on good track and paper machinery was lifting its head. Finland was a growing country, a teenager, at the time of my parents' youth.

We were so called typical Finnish christian family. We attended church maybe at Christmas, nothing more. A couple of burials, of course. The first one I remember was the founder of Töysän Linjat transportation company who was the uncle of my mother. Those were hilarious! I was about 5 years old back then and I remember the event like no other. It was a bit more high class burials than what I was used to. They had money and family. And a lot of employees and war time friends.

Finnish christianity means Lutheric Christianity. I won't teach you about the faith but I believe it's good to point out some typical characteristics of Lutheranism so you can understand my ground zero better. Lutherism is being Finnish - it's being humble and contributing to the common efforts. It's about forgetting yourself and focusing on what a man needs to do rather than what he wants to do. It's a good ground to build your ego on. It raises strong minded people. It raises people who see that success in life isn't about money or wealth. It's about being cool with yourself and spending enough time with yourself and your dear ones.

Truth, Love, Courage, Humour. Those are the values I count on. Those are everything to me. Those are life. I will tell you more about them later on the following pages.

Dad was from Karelia, Mom from the middle of the country. Dads family was a refugee family and moms was a land owner banker entrepreneur family. They met each other like many people do - while studying. They moved to Pori in search for work and life. We moved to Ulvila when I was about 1. Then Vuorela. Then Jyväskylä when I was 7. Then Lahti at the age of 21 and back to Jyväskylä when 24. Helsinki got me in 2003 and I've been a proud southern Finn since that.

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Alrighty then. Just to set the premises I need to tell you about the mental issues in my family. I know my grandpa was diagnosed with schizophrenia at some point. Judging from today's world view I would beg to differ. I believe he was shell shocked at the front during the was. He was a machine gun man and you know what that means? He was always in front. It must have been hell on earth. I cannot even start to think about that and the fact that he made it.

He told us kids only one story about his time in war. Today I know that it is a complete lie. I still don't know in detail level what he went through. It

must have been… I don’t know any other word for this but the finnish one - PERKELE

He told us kids that he was so young that he wasn’t able to attend service when the war started. He told us that when he was able to, he was sent to a military hospital to be a nurse assistant for a beginning. That took place in Hanko, southern Finland. He told us he was a hard core swimmer and of course we believed him because we were basically living our summers on a small island that they owned in lake Saimaa. We saw him swim. And he really was fast! He did it since a small boy and kept on doing it all the time. The only time he competed on it was on service. He won by a gap. And he wasn’t able to swim straight because he never swam in pool earlier and back in those days they didn’t have any lines between tracks. Funny. He was something this old man he surely was.

Then came a call. He was to board a train to Karelia. This is it - he thought. - Now I get to go and defend against those fucking invaders.

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Grandpa disembarked from the train close to the front line. About ten klicks away. They ate and double checked weaponry and other gear, last cleaning. Slept for a while. And then came the call.

He told us they were taken about five klicks with horse sledges in wintertime. It was about -10 celsius and something Fahrenheit. Go check yourself if you really want to know. It was ass freezing cold but not face freezing cold we would say in Finland. Rather nice a winter day.

They walked in formation the last five klicks and set their positions. A scout returned with the news - ‘they’ are close and moving this way. He said that there wasn’t any time remaining to dig in so everyone tried to find natural cover positions. He positioned himself behind a fat tree.

There came the ryssä. Shooting started by Finns. Ambushed Ruskis a bit. They recovered fast and took their positions and returned fire. Like they should. Professional survivors. Russians are a somewhat nasty army because it is amazingly huge. There is no way Finland can survive with its

“only” some 350.000 strong army without any help. No way. Ever. And this is why we need friends.

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My grandpa told he shot like crazy with his bolt lock rifle and he was so shaky at the moment he missed everyone. And then he took a shot in the knee and was sent back to Hanko to the same hospital where he was working before going into the battle.

And if you think about this - this is never true but we kids we didn’t question this old, tawny owl. He was our Gandalf the black. Because this man didn’t lose a hair or a colour. It’s ridiculous that all the generations after him we were bold. I have always wondered why boldness feels like a dominant gene. What purpose does it serve, c’mon?! Help me out here!

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I believe he really was stationed in Hanko for a starter and he was wounded at some point. All other things are completely made up. My auntie told me after his death that he was there for years and in machine

gun troops. Meaning - the worst places one can imagine. It was rather impressive that he didn't bear any bad faith against the Russians ever. At least he never said so. I believe he was able to make peace within himself after all. Otherwise I would think he was a bit messed up but the fact that he bore love within was amazing. Completely different from my mother's father. He was so traumatised that he was most of the time just quiet. Smoked a lot. Drank occasionally and was aggressive when drunk.

I believe many of the generation of my mom and dad were raised in complete PTSD. At least it would be weird if it wasn't so. The war time was terrifying and devastating. Not only in a physical way but even more in a mental. I feel so sorry for my parents that they needed to go through the fact that their parents were so unlucky and ended up in a war in which there are no winners.

Amazing times. Luckily the world today is easier for us Finns. But I really feel for Ukraine, Palestine, Iran and everyone else out there who encounter war. War is sooooo much about fears and stupidity and pride and stubbornness and fears - oh! Did I have two fears? Well. It's just right. Fears are the ones that dictate us. Not guide - dictate.

Alright. Now to Jyväskylä and comprehensive school, which starts when you're 6 or 7 in Finland. We moved from Kuopio. Vuorela is part of it nowadays. I was greeted with fear. Or stupidity. Not sure which. We were foreign to the suburb we lived in and you felt that in your skin when you were a child back then. There wasn't any real real violence at the early times, that came in later when we grew up. At the time I was in 1st and 2nd grades I was bullied a lot. I was the one who came outside so I was picked a lot. There were only two people in the suburb who didn't bully me. Well. Actually five but three of them were so nerdy guys that I was a bit scared of them. Weird guys. Nice, but weird.

For the 3rd grade I switched to heaven. I wasn't sure it was it at the time I applied but it made all the difference at the time. I applied and was selected to start my 3rd grade in music specific class. And you know what? The school was not located in the bloody suburb - it was located at the centre of Jyväskylä! I got to the big circles! - I thought.

And actually, I did after all. It really changed everything when we were burning our teens. When being found from the city gangs instead of suburb gangs your street status changes immediately. Why? Because everyone needs to feel safe in the city - no one needs to go to the suburbs. It also helped that I was an enthusiastic downhill skier. Snowboards were not in Finland yet. I did freestyle jumps, off-piste, speed, slalom, moguls… Whatever I could get myself into. I did about

1000 hours in a year at least three years in a row. I was a bit good at it as well, have to say. I didn't have fear. Until I did. And at that point I knew I must do something else. I couldn't advance no more with the fear handling skills I had back then. It would have required some extra coaching and I was afraid of it. I just wanted to enjoy in my way. In my framework. In my terms. And I have to say it's peculiar why didn't I never break a bone on the slopes. I was rugged, if you know what I mean. I drank a lot of milk because Teemu Selänne told me to. He was in every milk carton at the time. Milkman Selänne. National Hero.

Well. Because of the slopes the city crew loved me. They called me a teen doctor after the protagonist on the tv-series 'Teen Doctor.' And I got that. That was deserved, I guess. I kinda had the same looks. Not particularly proud of it but I do get it.

That was the kind of humour I liked and enjoyed. Something that can be grounded somehow, not just a trick. Like bullying - it's only a trick. But proper banter! Ribbing! Harsh but friendly teasing! That's the kind I like because it reflects love at the same time. You wouldn't have banter with your enemy. It's called something else at that point.

My dad was a person of big heart and a lot of great humour. From his point of view. To us it felt occasionally fun and occasionally embarrassing. Also I remember I felt disappointment, nothingness, ridicule, shame, pleasant surprises, great successes and everything in between. He was an arsenal full of love and joy towards life. I believe my mother had it as well back then but cannot remember for sure.

I remember him listening to dixie-jazz and watching Brothers Groucho, singing leads, learning everything about opera and operettes. He was like I am today. He was curious about life to the bottom of his heart. He studied all the time and taught the rest. He never rested. And still my mother told he was lazy. No. He was not. He just was way too into living the life. My warmest regards to Don Johnson Big Band at this point. They will understand why. You perhaps not. Listen to their records and you get it too.

We had a house in Jyväskylä which had a driveway that needed to be kept clean of snow all the time. Hideous job in the time in which we didn't have any money for motor operated plow. We all hated that but what could you do? It was a necessity to keep it open for the parents to get to work. We boys we used bus services which are absolutely top notch here in Europe, at least here in Finland. We also do have universal healthcare. Just saying…

But what I am most gracious to my late father is - he taught me what Monty Python and all the other Brit humour is all about! That was my gift from the gods! Faulty Towers. Not the nine o'clock news. Fast Track. C'mon! What did the Brits not do? They invented all the most important stuff! Damn Brits. Why do you need to be so good at that. Well. Luckily Finnish roadies are way better 😂

All changed when my dad died. He was in bad shape way before but somehow my child in me kept the whole thing under cover. I never questioned the fact that he was to survive. He had a brain tumor of bad diagnoses. Size of a fist - they found at the autopsy. His brain was eaten inside because of the tumor and crushed against his skull because of the uncontrollable swelling in his brain tissue due to the radiology. Fuck. He had no chance. And still I believed.

After all these years I think we kids should have been forced to the psychiatric way before, or even at the time of his death. It would have been lifesaving. But what can you do? You do what you can - nothing more. My mother was in so much pain that it was merely impossible for her to come into this kind of realization. I get it. Of course I do. She was about my age that I am now at the time of writing and her father had just died of cancer. He took part in some cancer medication thingy and he got it from there. They said 'sorry' so I believe everything's cool now.

And now. Her husband. What a blow even though she had started her current relationship about a year before my father's death. We called her a whore. Disloyal traitor. And stuff like that. You know? The stuff teenaged boys who are so deeply hurt say. And hurt we were. Deeply. So deeply you cannot imagine. So deeply I couldn't imagine myself until last year. I really honestly thought I was through everything after I cried for two consistent years after dad's death. No. I just buried my pain. I wasn't ever able to tell anyone about how fucking broke I was. So I just decided not to be anymore. I was tired and bored of that. So. I created myself a successful strong world man personality who has no weaknesses.

After my father was passed away my GrandMA2 died.

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Life was pain. Nothing but pain. Mother yelled at me. Didn’t give any space for me to try and cope with my pain. And my brother fell into depression as well. Not the best times. And my first real relationship ended when the girl kicked me out on the same day. A lot of hard things. High school at the same time. No wonder I was a bit lost at the time.

I was lost. So damn lost. I was interested in girls back at the time. Well. To be completely open and honest - I still am. But I didn't have any role models still alive for a man. I didn’t know how to approach a woman. Or a girl, I would say. And by talking about a man - I’m talking about a boy.

I had started my career already when I was 7. I started as a musician. Classical piano, choir and electric bass. And some theory and stuff. When I was 15 I had already played in a band for several years and had amazing gigs around. Pretty local stuff of course, but amazing nevertheless. I also organised events for my friends and worked at the local discotheque. Disco. Or Hill - as we locals called it. Because it was named Disco Hillside. Probably because it was built on a hillside.

We people from Jyväskylä, we have been super good with innovation and creativity. Lucky us.

After trying a journalistic career in Radio Jyväskylä - 97,7 MHz - I started my career at Lutakko - a somewhat famous rock club in Jyväskylä, Finland.

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One splendid thing I got to experience during my days in 97,7MHz was that I got to fly on a hot air balloon! That was friggin’ awesome! Sorry for the American way to put it but it truly was as inspirational to me than what all the americans seem to be fucking all the time. Can’t stand it. Not the Finnish way. Meaning - not the best way. Even the Swedes can do better. And we hate Swedes. Not like Russians, tho. Russians are invaders,

Sweds are just better than us in everything and we fucking hate it. Estonians can possibly understand. We have felt some brotherhood with the Estonians because of the similarities in our languages, history, underdogness and some other thinking similarities as well appear from time to time. Estonians are still way more Russian than what we are because they got rid of the big bear so much later. They still feel like eastern Europeans with their fear towards living free of fear. They have institutionalised their fear. And it's called Russia. It has been for ages and still is. It's Russian's way to govern people. Through fear.

Let's kill happiness and joy and free laughter! There will be less belief in yourself and your future after that! Great idea!

I just had a date with a girl from Azerbaijan. PhD. Social anthropologist. Complete nomad. Had travelled the world and the seven seas. Incredible person. Completely not my type but still a good and promising soul. You could see from her face her life had been different. She was such an interesting person. I hope I'll meet her again one day. So many interesting discussions. She was - for example - in Kosovo when it announced independence. So was I. Or actually, I was there a bit after. And I believe so was actually she as well but it sounded better to say it like that. Sorry. Misled you for the good of the story. Might happen again. Dunno. Let's see.

Anyways. We were in Kosovo at the same time without knowing about each other. She was doing her thing - I was part of NATO for a week or so. I sure as hell ain't no soldier who acts when told so. I'm an entertainer and that I will be till death takes me apart. But anyways. It sure was a fun trip. I'm not sure if I should say this but I got to fire some pretty impressive weapon systems and ride on proper offroad multi-function carrier. Thank you again so much, Mikko. And other Mikko as well, who after his service time became our tour bus driver for a couple of tours.

All the names beginning with the letter M are fine by me. Look at my daughters, for example. Mimmi and Myytti. Best names ever. Mimmi means a lass as in bonnie lass and Myytti means a myth. She's literally called Myth. Myytti. Superb names. I wish I could hold honours for either of them but no. Of course not. I'm not that smart. Other people are. I just get lucky once in a while.

Mimmi was an invention by her mother, Lea. I was sitting in a rocking chair and had a baby girl on my lap. I believe I watched some quiz game on TV or something, not sure. Lea, PhD but not at that point yet, was reading or knitting or whatever on a chair next to us. A bit diagonally opposite. Not sure how to explain it actually, forgive my Finnishness and not being interested enough to check my language and grammar. The

point was that she sat there. And took a look at us. Turned her head back for a minute or two, turns back and says - in so Finnish a way that is ever possible: “She looks like a Mimmi.” I responded: “ Why, yes she does.”

That was all of the conversation. Now you know a bit more about what it means to be a Finn. After that discussion her name was decided and we got to be silent again. It’s so painful when someone talks. It was to be Mimmi Maria. Maria comes from my mothers mothers mother. And her husband was Matti. And that is why I’m called Miika Matti. History is interesting. I don’t have much but what I do have has been very inspiring to me. Great families. Great losses. Great stories. Awful stories. Painful stories. Lots to learn from. A good base to build on. An Honor to be part of it.

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I visited my first summer rock festival when I was 16. I believe the headline was something like Aerosmith, maybe Beastie Boys… Who else… I remember I fell in love with a Finnish band called Itä-Saksa - East Germany. I became a fan and I did meet some of them later on the road. Superb act! I remember some other bands I was a fanboy back in the days who I cannot remember if they played there or not. I was 16yrs for god's sake. Don’t ask me impossibilities. We tried to get into a bar. No success. For me. As usual. I was just so young and I didn’t know it.

I started working in the rock club Lutakko when I was 17. It was volunteer work so no monetary benefit there. But hey - we have universal healthcare so you just don’t need to get huge benefits of what you do. You can just do what you feel like and that is the ultimate secret in Finnish and in the Nordic way of living. Hygge as some of the Scandifriends say. Was it Danes? I cannot remember because you never understand what a Dane talks about. I can do Svenska och Norsk a bit but hell no Danish. No one can. I believe they even themselves don’t know what they are talking about. They have a potato in their mouth when they talk. Complete nonsense is what comes out of them.

Beautiful country - ridiculous language. It would be better if they would just talk Norwegian or Swedish. Or Finnish as most of the reasonable people do. I just don’t get why they say Finnish is hard. I learned it when I was a baby! How hard can it be for an adult to learn it?

Yes. Funny.

Thank you. I believe there was a bit of Ismo Leikola on that. Not sure how much but I believe he had said something alike. Well. If it’s like that then it is. I don’t claim any copyrights to my phrases. Or well… On second thought… Maybe I don’t say that aloud because that can be beneficial for some T-shirt prints. I think I should get royalties of some sort if I’m quoted in commercial use. It’s actually not about money - it’s about ownership. It’s about what is right.

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After my first experience with a summer festival I was sold. The atmosphere was astonishing. It was what I really was after. Fun. That was Ruisrock, Turku, Finland. And the year was -94.

I went to work in Lutakko after that, as I mentioned. First contact with a light board, or console. Whatever. I don't care. The thing that you wiggle and hit in random sequences. The story goes like this and it includes a tall audio dude who - of course - had played in some semi famous band and something. You know the drill. Basic roadie stuff.

And please. Please notice again the beauty and lyricism in Finnish dialogues.

Miika - What's that?
Jyrki - A lighting console
Miika - How does it work?
Jyrki - You push the button. The light goes on
Miika - Can I give it a go?
Jyrki - Yes

And that was it. Again. How lovely and effective a way to talk we have here in Finland.

And please, do notice why this is so beautiful - There is no way on earth to talk to anyone else like that except the people whom you trust and understand that they will not harm you by purpose. It's wonderful to be among people like that. You don't have to be anything - you can - yes - just - be.

And then died my father. I lost everything. I lost my safety.

And then dies my grandpa. Another hit in the already lost soul.

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Kickstart

So. The beginning was a bit - Hectic if you say. A lot happened and I still didn’t even start on talking about the band and the music. Suddenly I feel like I should say something. It might give the following generations some ideas about what to listen - if not any other.

I am a grunge child, you can’t take it away from me. But let’s rewind even more. Let me walk you through my passion for music. It’s big. But on the other hand it’s not a bit bigger than any other person’s who just happen to like music. I like music and the control of my feelings it provides. If you ever have felt the ‘soundtrack of my life’ moment - you know exactly what I’m talking about. And if you know that feeling, you absolutely understand why it’s not even understandable but even more like mandatory for me to tell you what music means to me. What it is to me.

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Well. To be honest the music in me came from my father’s side of the family but hey - what can a simple writer do? Mother’s milk is an expression that we Finns use as well. But in Finnish, of course. The Finnish Word of Today is - Äidinmaito. Say it with me - Äidinmaito.

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Back to the Mother’s milk and the really hard thing about it that I just cannot pass somehow. My brain is just fixated innit. The thing that amuses me so much with it is that the equivalent version for a father would be… Yes. Fathers jizz/spunk. You got it. And it would then suggest me… Yes. Sorry about the language here. Blowing my dad. The picture in my mind is rather dirty and nasty and I would like to skip it entirely but you just wanted me to explain this to you so you could look at me and say - what a joke this guy is! A blubbering idiot! What can this person know about anything?

And that is exactly my point in all of this. What can I know?

If you stop and think about the same question when it comes to you - you might get confused, but don’t stop there. It’s just a temporary state. You’ll get over it. I did. And I’m just a blubbering idiot.

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My Grand granddad, Mr. Hugo Primus Riikonen, was an organ player in church. We say ‘kanttori’ which translates to real English, not the US English, as church organist.

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Primus - the first. I don’t know our history any further. They lived in Viipuri, in Karelia. They lived in an area which is called “Russia” at the moment. That is something that is so hard to forget. Think about if it was your country we’re talking about here. Think about it for a second.

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Actually. Let’s hit page break here just to remember everyone who has served. And even more - we should remember the leaders who have forced them to act like predators and beasts.

Shame Mr. Putin.

Shame Mr. Netanjahu.

Shame Mr. Trump. For being such a fucking pussy to bend on Netanjahu. Pussy. Pussy pussy pussy.

Shame on every leader who does not appreciate, understand or cherish the value of decency. And just to show you all how freedom of speech works in Finland (we can say anything here) - Shame on you Mr. President Stubb - for being such a great lighthouse in the darkness! I hate you for being so amazingly good! I want to be good too! I want that shame on me, too! Kiitos!

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the act of love. Kindness is only a child to decency Jacob. Decency is god, Kindness is Jesus.

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Everything in being human is about being decent towards everyone around you. Not only some. Everyone.

It’s fucking pathetic that this is masked nowadays in terms such ‘culturally open-minded’ or ‘racist’ or ‘egalitarian.’ It’s all about decency. Being decent. And that is what your mother should have taught you. I know all mothers are not perfect either and so are not the childhoods of our mothers’ either.

You don’t need a 48 year old Finnish roadie to come and tell you that. You know it already if you would trust yourself. But you don’t and you fear. You fear change. You fear difference. And you don’t know why? Well let me tell you. Feeling of ‘weirdness’ arises when you encounter different people (or things) than usual. It’s an evolutionary thing and it happens to the best of us occasionally. ‘Weird’ is just your brain telling you to look for more info

on the topic. It’s your brain saying - I don’t understand - to you. If you get and embrace that, you will do better in your life. I guarantee.

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After Hugo came Jorma. Yeah I know - not as fancy a name here. And to be honest - Jorma means also a dick in Finnish. It’s the same thing if you would name your child ‘Dick’. I bet the Finnish language was a bit different back then between the wars. My god. Have to laugh at the fact, though.

Jorma really looked like a tawny owl. I mean really. His eyebrows were mas-sive! It’s like the nose of my friends Mika (S) or Toni (L). Their smell sensory devices are hu-mongous man!

Anyway - I believe my grandpa was able to play every instrument on earth with them eyebrows. He really had music in him. I want to believe that was because of the war traumas. Shell shock. PTSD. Whatever you want to call it. But I believe he just found some relief via music. I believe he just found happiness and never excused or explained himself anymore after the war. At least if I would have survived - I wouldn’t. But I didn't, so what do I know? Just guessing here. And this is what Carl Jung is talking about. I suggest you check Jungian personality types. They still apply today.

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Jorma was DC - Not Dick. Director Cantus. The leader of the choir. He was a music man to the bone. And then he swam. I don't know if he ever did anything else. Walked. Walked a lot. And then some. He was one happy man. And therefore I believe he was diagnosed with 'weirdness.' Something that wasn't known at that time. Think about it. How unknown happiness was to Finland's inhabitants back then straight after the war. I think he just thought - Fuck it! I survived the war. I can be whomever I am.

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My aunt and my dad were raised in that environment. Two teachers and one of them was DC. Auntie is a pianist/teacher, my dad was lead tenor / teacher.

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Dad was a pilot as well. Airman. Also he did his service running telephone lines in the woods. He was a communications officer. Well. Sergeant. Nothing fancy. I still remember the last words he spoke while in service – Mr. Leutnant! One thing is for sure! I will be here not a single day more!

And then off he went. Back home. Leutnant was left out laughing. LOL. First LOL of my life.

Well then. Dad was diagnosed with a brain tumor back in something… Was it -94? I believe so. He just turned 41 if I'm not mistaken here. We were kids - we didn't understand but his behaviour became irrational directly after that. And why wouldn't it do so? Think about it. If you hear that you're going to die - how straight can you walk? And on the same go - how straight should you walk? I think there's no real rules that apply here. If he wanted to buy a new car - I get it, even though we never had money when we were kids.

We never had money. Why? Not because my parents didn't work. This was due to my mother and her family.

My mother's dad was a banker. Or actually - a bank director. He ran one bank for a bank group after the war until retirement. Säästöpankki. Bank for savings. Yet another innovative name from the Finns. He taught what it means to be rich. It doesn't mean you have a lot of money. It meant that your cost or your expenses sum less to your income. And this is why we always ate porridge and macaroni cannerole. Cheapest of the cheapest. But tasty, I'm not actually complaining. But what I'm saying is that you will become rich when you get more than you spend. It's - once again - simple as that. And this is why I have always been able to do what I like to. More about it later.

Mother's mother was Aino Töysä. Yes. That Töysä. She came from the family estate "Töysä" which is currently a town in mid Finland. She was a daughter of Matti Töysä and Maria Monthán. At least Maria is buried in a UNESCO landmark - the church of Petäjävesi. Not 100% sure about Matti. But this is why I'm called Miika Matti Riikonen and why my daughter is Mimmi Maria Riikonen. I believe Matti actually did something crazy with the estate later on after the war - possibly inebriated? Or completely wasted, as we Finns were about 60 years after the war. Cell phone cameras changed everything. We became shy because we don't dare to express ourselves when drunk anymore. And that led to a nationwide depression boom. And ADHD.

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I started as a volunteer in Rock Club Lutakko in Finland. I did the cloakroom, cleaned and so forth. I wasn't able to sell beer or anything because I was still 17 years old. Legal limit in Finland is 18 years and good that it is. It's one of the most recruiting professions within the students or youngsters. This place was run by an association for live music in Jyväskylä - JELMU ry. A Child of ELMU ry. And Eeka Mäkynen was once in VELMU ry. And so on. There was an association for every city. Fantastic system! So we were volunteers and we had about 3-5 shows a week.

I was drawn into the music world when I was kid. By my family, of course. I think I saw some operas before I was born. La Bohème, perhaps, if you think about my life. I'm sure I remember my dad saying my first words were: "Sì, mi chiamano Miika!" I wonder how that was even possible before exiting the pussy but I know my dad was a resourceful man. And mother… She was… Decent. In the sense of the Latin word 'decere' is the root word for it and the same 'decere' is the root word for 'dignity'. Decency is about dignity as well. Or dignity is about decency - not sure which.

Anyways. The instruments that I've played for some time have been classical piano and electric bass. And from now on it's called BASS only. And the fish joke isn't any fun. Bass Bass Bass - Davie504. Listen to that. It's like the 42 in Hitchhiker's Guide. It's the alpha and the omega. It's the universe. "And I don't want to hear - no violin"

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Most of my bass time I played in a band called ‘Downstairs Band.’ Mate - what did I tell you about the Finnish innovation skills on naming things? We named ourselves that because… I think you got it - our rehearsal space was? Affirmative. Downstairs. Stupid name. But think about my friends who came up with the most stupidest name in the world - Apulanta. For my Brit friends it’s about the same as ‘Goose Shit.’ And they broke through! They made it! And we got many better options such as

Stories

Now every roadie book has its own stories. The road was all about stories. No one cared if someone had a million in their pocket or a dime. It really, honestly, didn’t make a difference. The only thing we cared about was the goodness in others. We hated the audience because they were so suspicious. You weren’t able to tell if they had good intentions or not. We met every sort. It forced us to pull ourselves a bit from the surrounding world. I think it was called brotherhood. I think it is called brotherhood. I think we’re all brothers in arms.

I’ll share an example of the world we lived in. I don’t do that no more and I know most of these things went away when people got themselves their cell phones with cameras on ‘em. That killed fun. Spotify / Record labels killed the industry and wellbeing of artistae. Everyone’s so afraid in the eye of the hurricane called ‘change’ that no-one can really act rationally.

These stories are not all OK in the eyes of today's minds but this was how it was. This was our lives at the time and we knew no better. I really mean that. I didn’t know. I wasn’t able to. How would I have been? I was broken inside. There weren't any role models for me. Well. Les Claypool and Trent Reznor. But that wasn’t much I guess. Great musicians - too distant for father replacements.

I will now tell you some short stories from the road without any explanation. You might find some of them offensive, some of them disgusting, some of them full of life, some of them filled with brotherhood. And two things that combine them all - we were never afraid to be who we were and we tried to live to the max. We lived for experiences. And we were not always the most polite people in the world. My deepest and most sincere apologies about what I have done to everyone I have hurt so deeply on my road.

These stories are not in chronological order except one - I'll tell the newest one last because it's so sweet of a story and it really ties all knots together. Katharsis - if you may. Also - I will black out, or redact, everyone who have not given her or his permission for public callout.

Example: ~~Janne Röning~~

You wouldn't ever guess who I'm talking about, would you?

OK. Shall we? It's the moment that you've been waiting for and the actual reason you bought the book. The stories are:

1. How we made a human pyramid naked in snow
2. How we came up with a new sports called 'Poppers Diving' and 'Jägermeister Diving'
3. Most offensive and most funniest crazyparty ever
4. Kristiania
5. Glauchau
6. Raahe tervis ja zc
7. Tokyo
8. Jämsä suburban
9. First journey
10. Jenni Vartiainen - Paluu
11. Elastinen - Hki city festival
12. Mirella - terkut Myytille

1.

The story of how we made a human pyramid while naked on snow.

We were on a tour with a band called Pariisin Kevät - The spring in Paris. I think the band got its name from the spring in Prague (1968). Or not. I might be mistaken. Anyways. We were in a small place in the middle of nowhere in Finland called Äänekoski. It was winter - of course. Only half of the year in Finland. Well. A quarter if you're honest.

I remember quite a lot of it but who cares about backstages, free booze or magic tricks so let's skip 'em. Gig done and dusted - and that's when the real fun starts, innit.

So we're heading back to the hotel, having a proper laugh, when someone comes up with an absolutely brilliant idea - reckon we could pull off a three-tier human pyramid?
Blinding idea!
Then someone tops it - what if we did it starkers? In the middle of a snowdrift. Right outside the hotel lobby.
Even better idea!
So off come the clothes and there we are, bare as the day we were born, grunting and sweating trying to build this bloody pyramid in the snow - which, as it turns out, is considerably harder than it looks.
Now here's a subplot worth noting - simultaneously, one of our crew is climbing up the marquee of a local tyre company called Laden Rengas (Lade's Tires) to tape the word 'Bin' in front of the company name. Starkers, naturally.
Round about four or five in the morning the police roll in.
Two of our lads - Ilari and Kari - spots 'em and wearing nothing but their shirts at this point - cool as cucumbers (pun intended) - they stroll over, lean on the police car window like they're ordering a pint at the local and go:

Kari: No trouble here. Everything's fine.
Ilari: Just here with some mates… Taking holiday snaps.

The entire pyramid collapsed instantly. Everyone on the ground, naked, crying with laughter.

The officer looks at them. Pauses.

"Right. Perhaps time for the last photos then?"

Never noticed the naked guerrilla artist up on the marquee directly in front of the meat wagon because of the 'beautiful' distraction we made up!

I swear I live in a sitcom. Best life ever. Honest!

2.

The story of how we came up with a new sports called 'Poppers Diving' and 'Jägermeister Diving'

3.

The story of the most offensive and most funniest crazyparty ever

This is without question the second most embarrassing story of my career. But that's exactly why it's worth telling - because when you really look at it, there's nothing to be ashamed of. This is just life. And it really was life lived to the absolute fullest, I should point out.

We were playing with Apulanta at the Kuopio Wine Festival some years back now - decades almost. Gig came, gig went. Same old story. Did all the things you do every day anyway. Nobody cares about that. Extra nonsense. The gig is beside the point.
But it was a wine festival, after all. And we like wine. Or well - we liked alcohol.
So a couple of bottles in hand and off towards the accommodation. They'd put us up at a place called Iso-Valkeinen. No idea what to expect, never been before.

Bloody hell what a dump it was. But there was nothing for it except to drink so enormously that it stopped mattering. What I hadn't quite clocked when things got going was that these weren't exactly normal parties. These were the most chaotic parties of my entire career to that point. And it's not about drugs - again. We were simply living. Yes. Life in full.

Keys in hand and straight down to the beach to drink and swim and go completely mental. Christ it was fun though. Worth mentioning as a small detail from that beach - I encountered a Finnish ancient god there. Ahto.

Ahto is the Finnish god of the sea and waters from the Kalevala - the king of the deep who lives in the depths with his wife Vellamo. Stern but fair. Gives or takes the fishermen's catch as he sees fit.

Cool god-bloke.
Well. It happened quite suddenly that as I was pleasantly sipping my long drink on the jetty, Ahto rose from the water beside me, trident in hand, and bellowed in his great divine voice: "I am Ahto, King of the Sea!"

The sight was utterly, completely, staggeringly, speechlessly, jaw-droppingly magnificent. Like a trout leaping in the rapids in the shimmer of the last or first rays of sun. Like a ringed seal surfacing to greet a rower on Saimaa.

As I gathered myself from the astonishment I noticed this seal bore a remarkable resemblance to one Matti Tukia. You don't need to know

anything about Matti. And neither does he, for that matter. He's a man who knows himself. Or knew. You can never be sure if someone's dead by the time this book comes out. Same goes for me. And for you. Well. Not you you, obviously, since you're there reading these lines - but you in the passive sense. You get it. And if you don't, I couldn't care less.

Matti was such a magnificent sight that I immediately decided to lick his chest conspicuously so the lovely ladies on the beach would laugh even more at the spectacle, and so I'd look like a harder man than Matti.

Right.

Didn't quite anticipate what I'd done by playing Gene Simmons. I had never before licked a truly, properly sweaty human being by the chest hair. The threshold was crossed. The attack was immediate. The ratio was spot on. And the release…

Oh the release.

What a genuinely wonderful thing it was to properly vomit - for once really properly - onto another naked human body's temple such that it surely flew in through the windows and doors as well. The taste was just so horrifically, catastrophically awful. Straight onto the Jallu and long drinks after that to get Tukia's taste out of my mouth. Good God what a generous man he is - both from the mouth and the sweat.

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It's the official beverage of Finnish rock tours, fishing trips, midsummer bonfires, and situations that

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Right. That was naturally only the overture to the fanfares - and quite a few of those were unleashed by our little herd over that long night.

There were four men and four women. Or well - let's face it. Four boys and four girls. Pretty good combo for a proper party, no? It was that traditional Finnish summer carrying on - the sun never set all night and we were simply having a pleasant afternoon after work. That's genuinely what it was to us. Next day sleep on the bus and the whole thing starts again. Our lives as groundhogs. But not today. Today we had a party. Sometimes everyone just needs a party.
What really got us was that our backline tech Mehtis had reinvented himself. He no longer wanted to drink with us. Which is absolutely infuriating. And then the bastard was actually proud of it - going on about how he's the new Mehtis now. Bloody idiot Espoo-boy. Been backline tech for Twisted Sister and now the common man's booze ain’t good enough for the posh Espoo lad, for crying out loud.

We wanted old Janne back. And all that was available was new Janne. We decided to act.
And what else does a troupe of monkeys know how to do except be monkeys? Give us a break, come on. The women were women and naturally didn't take part in this, but us lads stripped all the bedding from one bed, pissed the whole mattress absolutely soaking, then carried the bed in a group - stark naked, naturally - around the outside of the building to Mehtis's room and dropped it upside down on top of Janne.

We bounced on the mattress on top of Janne and chanted in chorus: We want old Janne back!
Mehtis didn't appreciate it.

Funny that. Came right out of nowhere for us.
We thought we were cheering him up.

No we bloody didn't. We were just so furious that he wasn't our mate in that stuff anymore. And he needed a taste of the truth.

Mehtis would have killed us if his boss hadn't been there. This is what the roadie life is sometimes. You don't go crying to court about these things. You get revenge. I don't know when, and nobody else does either, but nobody ever forgets these things and they're always avenged. An eye for an eye is the law of the road.

Right. That wasn't everything but it was the most important bits. I can mention a couple more things from that evening because there were a few more events. I wouldn't normally bother, but I need to get some length into this book so people think it's good. Isn't that how it goes - the thicker the better? Or was it longer? Well. Mine is thick but not long.

I had sex in the shower that night - taking a lovely youngish woman from behind, who was genuinely nice and understood life. I liked her a lot. Worth mentioning, I'd say. Without a condom. I finished on the small of her back in a gentlemanly fashion and said: "Heartfelt thanks."

Alec Hirst-Gee - you've left a permanent impression on me. Alec is - for those who don't know - the only bloke I know who wipes his arse from the front. The British are completely bloody peculiar lot. Isn't that right Lewis? Isn't that right Kevin? Isn't that right every single one of you.

Except you Paris. You're a one remarkable human being. Well.. Nina, too. And many other as well. My greets to Arielle on the same go here!

Right. There was other fun stuff that evening as well. Before this pornographic scene we'd all been in the shower together - all eight of us.

Or so I thought.

Until I noticed Ahto pissing on all of us. Matti was standing beside the toilet on the rim and urinating a warm stream at chest height onto all the rest of us.

Well. That was also a new experience. Strange situation. Surprising. Not actually frightening in any way - more pleasant in the sense that the shower water was running a bit cool and the piss warmed things up nicely in a funny way. And it didn't last long. And the water washed it straight away. So I concluded there's probably nothing to say about this seeing as

it doesn't really bother me anyway. Fine by me. Too late now to cry in any case. Carpe Diem.

And then there was also the business of giving one particular fellow an enema with the hand shower - the pussy telephone, as we Finns call it. Pillupuhelin. Shoutout Irene Idänvalo. Took the handle off and then assisted with some lubricant (soap) to get the hose into this brave irrigatee's anus, then turned the tap on very carefully. We followed the instructions of the person being flushed and were simply curious participants in the situation.

And yes, the bowel did empty. And yes, he did feel considerably better afterwards. And yes, the cleaner was surprised in the morning by the river of shit leading from the bathroom to the bedroom.

I don't know if this story can continue but the truth is it didn't actually end here even though you probably wish it had.

What also happened was that suddenly someone noticed it was already eight in the morning and for some reason a cleaner was approaching the building. Apparently someone had been disturbing the breakfast guests in a state of undress. Apparently by swimming naked in front of their panoramic window. Full sprint to the bus to hide and trying to ring our driver awake.

- I am not bloody waking up!
- For God's sake Lamberg! I pay your sodding wages! You get your ass here right now!

The cleaner had already gone to inspect the Sodom and Gomorrah damage and was running in distress, skirt flapping, with tears in her eyes towards the main building.
Lamberg arrived immediately after. Then foot to the floor and away.

And then almost immediately, after a kilometre or two, we realised we'd accidentally left the hotel's actual keys behind and absolutely had to go back to return them or we'd end up in court.

- Shit
- Fuck
- SHITFUCK

A word on Blind Fury before we continue.

Blind Fury is a 1989 American action film starring Rutger H

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It was pretty embarrassing going back to return those keys. But nothing to be done. You reap what you sow, don't you.
One small postscriptum I must add here, though - it wasn't long before Kimmo Hirvonen - not the lawyer, the gig promoter. Elli's less attractive and lazier husband - rang us to say what the hell have you lot been up to now. Grown men.

We listened to this for a moment and then the master himself, Toni Wirtanen - the War God of Heinola - uttered his immortal words. Or well. Uttered. He said them in a rather… how shall I put it… majestic? Emphatic? Well. Effective, in any case:

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There was really no arguing with that from Kimmo's side. He calmed down considerably faster this time than when we accidentally destroyed eight snowmobiles. A few of them in pretty bad shape. But when you have to race hard against rally drivers nobody wants to give in. Bloody hell.

Sisu, bloody hell, for all the Finnish angry women.
The power of vitutus for all the Pekka Tavis.
The power of the right ‘ump for all the Ellis Frosts.
It’s the power of being tight for all the Casey Neistats.

It’s the power of being hella pissed for all the Tony Hawks.
The power of uf de Sack for all the Jonny Gigers.
The power of Hara ga tatsu for all the Coco Yoshizawas out there.

4.

The story about Christiania

Here's another one of those slightly more amusing stories.

We were on the road with Suburban Tribe, playing gigs in Copenhagen and Århus. As these things go, all sorts happened on that trip as well.

The short version - we left Helsinki on the tour bus, drove to Turku, caught the ferry, went through Sweden and landed in Copenhagen. Nothing to it really. It was a fair distance though, and once again I was reminded of that unwritten truth of the trade - most of your working hours are spent either waiting or travelling. There. Now it's written as well. The upside was I always had time to read, play, study or draw. Whatever took my fancy. I lived pretty freely even though I was locked up in a tin cow on the motorway.

We rolled into Copenhagen in the afternoon and parked our tin train in front of the swimming hall next to the central station. Because we liked saunas and swimming. Obviously. Why else?
And what was the tour crew's very first collective thought?

Christiania

- or more officially, Freetown Christiania. Here's the short version:
In 1971 a bunch of hippies and anarchists occupied an abandoned military area in Copenhagen's Christianshavn district. Declared themselves an independent state - their own rules, their own society, none of Denmark's laws. At its peak about a thousand people lived there. Pusher Street was an open drug market - mainly cannabis. Denmark turned a blind eye for a long time because Christiania was also a genuine social experiment - communal living, art, freedom. In the 2000s the Danish government tried several times to shut it down or normalise it. After a long fight, in 2011/2012 Christiania bought the land from the state - collectively, together. That was a historic moment. Today it still exists. And in 2024 the residents themselves dug up the cobblestones of Pusher Street as a symbolic gesture - closing the open drug market on their own terms. Nobody told them to. They just decided. Living proof that you can do things differently - imperfectly but stubbornly.

Christiania is a brilliant place. I reckon I could live there and be accepted as myself. Or at least I'd like to think so. Id. Not Ego. Kant.
Anyway, off we went, straight to Christiania's lovely bar terraces. Had a few wet and fizzy drinks there and on the way out we stopped by the Pusher and picked up one considerably impressive tiger spliff. For those of you who don't partake - a tiger means a mix of hash and weed. The patch and the bud, if you will.

Now. None of us were particularly heavy smokers at the time, so when we shared it by the river just outside Christiania, I ended up in a rather remarkable state. I suddenly couldn't see more than about a metre in front of my face. Which was absolutely hilarious. I navigated purely by hearing - following the sound of Finnish being spoken and walking towards it.

Those of you who are afraid of weed really don't understand what a wonderful and funny product it is at its best. Its so-called worst quality is that it forces you to face yourself. And that - as you all know - is pretty much humanity's greatest fear without exception. That's why people are so scared of it. Nobody has ever committed a murder, a rape or a bank robbery while stoned - can you guess why? Because a stoned person is about as threatening as a tortoise. If you point your finger at one it just goes - oi mate, no need to be like that. That scares me!

Look at Snoop. Q.E.D.

So, we wandered around for a while. I don't remember much about the walk back to the city centre except that suddenly there were Chinese lanterns everywhere. Which makes me suspect to this day that Copenhagen has a Chinatown or something - but I've never dared to verify it, because what if it doesn't? What were those Chinese lanterns then?

Next thing I remember we walked into a McDonald's. Except we didn't quite manage that either. We'd apparently come in through the back door. Suddenly there we were, right next to the staff behind the wrong side of the counter - a whole group of large long-haired musicians and roadies. The bewilderment was probably equal on both sides. A genuinely beautiful moment in its own way. We shared so much mutual confusion right there on the spot.

When the potato-mouthed Danes eventually got us guided to the right side of the counter I understood the value of branding. All I could get out was "Big Mac Ateria ja Kokis" - in Finnish, mind you - but the staff wisely understood immediately what was needed, punched it in and that was that. Coke in hand, waiting for the bögöö. Thäts burger if you pronounce

it, written in Finnish. Böögö. Burger. It sounds absolutely the same. And böögö looks so much better than burger!

And that's where the memory ends again. The next thing I remember is leaving enthusiastically for the swimming hall in the morning and discovering they had a climbing wall. I was at the peak of my climbing fitness at the time so I enjoyed that enormously.

But what the hell is wrong with people - we Finns invented the sauna, so why is it that in other countries you can never throw water on the stones? Who watered down the plan? Who made a sauna without löyly? I'm asking! Come forward immediately and I'll take you for a proper sauna session, bloody hell. Korhonen Matti and Noora will come along and have a word with you while me and Tatu sit on a stove and drink vodka.

I've never had a personal "problem" with weed. Sometimes I've enjoyed it, sometimes not. Sometimes used it for longer stretches, sometimes gone long periods without. I've surfed with it pretty lightly really, partly because I haven't drunk much alcohol for as long as I can remember. I might have one or two, happily with food even, but getting drunk just doesn't interest me. That lost its meaning a long time ago. I've done my share. I do it only if someone pays me to do it.

All the roadies in the world know what I'm talking about. We only drink at work. Weird, black suited people we are.

5.

The story about Glauchau

Oopsie. Another party. Glauchau, Eastern Germany after the fall of the wall.

Glauchau is a small town in the German state of Saxony, sitting on the banks of the river Mulde between Zwickau and Chemnitz. Population around 22,000.

Its roots go back to the 12th century when it was founded as a Sorbian and Wendish settlement. The town is dominated by a remarkable twin castle complex - two medieval castles separated by a moat, one from the 12th century and one from the 15th, which now house museums, an art gallery and a music school.

During the Industrial Revolution Glauchau became an important centre for textile manufacturing. It has a complicated 20th century history - Nazi party activity in the 1920s and 30s, damage in 1945, then decades behind the Iron Curtain as part of East Germany.

Today it's a quiet, architecturally interesting town - Renaissance and Baroque buildings, a villa district with Art Nouveau mansions, and those two castles in the middle of everything.

Traveling is so much fun. For the first time. Not for long. You just eat your Miles however you can. Usually games, books, music, more books, tutorial videos, steven bartlett, hank greene, youtube, davie, Ziroth, Smarter every Destin, Everything related with curiosity, advanced thinking, space in general, physics in general, natural sciences in general, languages, behaviourism, philosophy, board games, card games, football, other sports. That was touring all about for me. A band of misfits trying to cope together in the world.

And if you think about it - it’s pretty much of a description for the greatest team work culture ever! Do it roadie style!

Right, that's enough of me bleedin' yappin'. The party's waitin', innit.

So - it turned out that this was our last gig of the whole run - just over a month on the road. And the day before had been one of the rare days off we had on the entire tour. Something like 36 days, 28 gigs plus the drives to Germany and back through Sweden naturally.

So off to have a look at lovely Glauchau then. And what happened next became quite unexpectedly one of the most extraordinary experiences of my life. That little town was like something out of a fairy tale. Like a film set. I had never seen anything so beautiful. Something similar perhaps once on the Scottish moors, but this - this was completely, utterly, mind-blowingly, jaw-droppingly magnificent. The only chain store I remember from the whole place was a Lidl.

The streets were narrow and rolling cobblestone lanes. I could almost hear the horses still echoing through them from somewhere back in history. And there at the edge of town sat an almost incomprehensibly beautiful little castle. Or actually two - but at first I thought there was only one.

Right. So - Glauchau. A small town in Saxony, Germany. About 22,000 people. Sits on the river Mulde between Zwickau and Chemnitz. You've never heard of it and that's completely fine. Neither had I before I ended up there.

But here's the thing about Glauchau. It's got two castles. Not one. Two. Right next to each other, separated by a moat, sitting on a ridge above the river like they've been there forever - which they have, more or less. The older one, Hinterglauchau, goes back to around 1170. The Schönburg family built it. Noble lot. Ruled the area for centuries. The second one, Forderglauchau, was added in the 1520s when apparently the first one wasn't quite enough of a castle for them. Fair enough really - if you've got the land, build the castle. I understand that kind of thinking.

The Schönburg family held onto these two beauties right up until 1945 when the Russians arrived and said - right, that's enough of that, cheers. Dispossessed. Just like that. The castles then spent the DDR years as a music school and residential building which is either the saddest or the most beautiful thing that's ever happened to a medieval castle depending on your point of view. I choose beautiful. Music in a castle.

Obviously.

Today one houses a museum and art collection, the other a library and music school. Five euros to get in. Unbeatable. The fear hole in the courtyard is apparently worth seeing as well. I mean - a fear hole. Of course it is.

Well. At the time, Absinthe wasn’t the original absinthe anymore.

Absinthe originated in the late 18th century in the Val-de-Travers region of Switzerland - ironically close to Giger country. A French doctor named Pierre Ordinaire is credited with creating it around 1792 as a medicinal remedy.

The Pernod Fils distillery in France commercialised it in the early 1800s and it became the drink of the Parisian bohemian scene throughout the 19th century. Verlaine, Rimbaud, Toulouse-Lautrec, Van Gogh, Oscar Wilde - they all drank it. It was called la fée verte - the green fairy.

At its peak in the 1890s the French were drinking 36 million litres a year. Then the temperance movement and wine industry lobbied hard against it, claiming it caused madness and hallucinations - largely blaming the compound thujone found in wormwood. It was banned across most of Europe and the USA between 1905 and 1915.

The ban was lifted in most countries in the early 2000s when studies showed thujone levels were never high enough to cause what was claimed. The madness was probably just alcohol.

Traditional and historical ingredients:

- ☐ Grand wormwood *(Artemisia absinthium)* - the key botanical, source of thujone
- ☐ Green anise
- ☐ Florence fennel
- ☐ Small wormwood *(Artemisia pontica)*
- ☐ Hyssop
- ☐ Melissa
- ☐ Angelica root
- ☐ Juniper
- ☐ Nutmeg

- Various other herbs depending on the producer

Modern ingredients are largely the same - grand wormwood, anise and fennel remain the holy trinity. The difference is controlled by thujone levels.

We also visited one lovely bar/coffee house when we were there. I cannot remember all the things we did there but one thing was so good that I should tell you about it.

So we went into a café or a bar - well it was the middle of the day so let's call it a café. Sat down, had some pastry and a hot drink, and I fancied a cigarette. Back in those days you could still smoke indoors. Only there was no ashtray on the table.

Now. I had studied German at school. So I walked up to the lady behind the counter and very brilliantly proceeded to ask her:

- Entschuldigung, bitte - kann ich haben eine... eine... eine... öööööö... Eine Aschentaschen!

She stared at me. Stared some more. And then her face did exactly what faces do in cartoons when someone has an idea. The transformation was something to behold. She turned on her heel, reached out her hand, picked up a small elegant glass ashtray, turned back to face me, smiled gently and said:

- Aschenbecher

Now. For those of you who don't speak German - and let's be brutally honest, most of you don't - here's why this is funny.

Aschenbecher. That's the real word there. Ashtray. Simple, clean, two syllables. Aschen - ash. Becher - cup. Job done. Or so would you think.

What I said was Aschentaschen. Which means ash pockets. Or ash bags. Essentially I walked up to a perfectly innocent German woman and asked her if I could have some ash pockets please.

She stared at me because she was trying to work out if I was having some sort of episode or if I was just Finnish. Then she figured it out, picked up the ashtray, handed it to me and gently corrected me like you would a

child who has just said something completely wrong but with enormous confidence.

Which is exactly what I was.

Aschentaschen. And I stand by it. It made me perfect sense at the time. Still does in a weird way.

6.

Two short stories about a place called ‘Raahe’

Burden

And how to get over it

Success

And how I define it

Timestamp

The hardest thing in life - and the ultimate life hack - is to be confident. Not to try to be confident. To be confident. To be. Siddharta, Shinto, Zen, Tao, Heaven, whatever. Hell and heaven are on earth, not the afterlife. There is no afterlife. When you die it’s all over. And it is an incredibly good

thing that it is so. And when you realise it - you'll understand that there is absolutely no value in individualism at all and that that doesn't mean you need to diminish yourself a bit either - you will be closer to your peace. Happiness equals peace. Peace equals happiness.

End all wars. Because of happiness. Because of love. Because of you should face your fears. Because you will be better when you understand that every form of aggression is actually just you screaming out loud - I am scared. I am scared of something.

It's actually rather simple if you think about it. Take our favourite topic as an example. Fuckface Trump. Living Pig. Orange Baffoon. He is most probably being blackmailed by Asshole Netanjahu. You know? The Jew that fucks up the lives of all the rest Jews around the world? That guy. The guy who will probably kill me for this. Trump is a pussy so he cannot handle a valiant Finn but Jew are more tough people. They have been forged in hell as we all know. They have suffered. No man or woman should ever suffer how they have. I mean - I cannot even start to think about the amount of Blood, Sweat and Tears (pun intended) the people of one religion or tribal ancestry has shed for the world to understand something about how bad a human can treat a kind.

Honestly now. Look yourself in the mirror and tell me that you are a person deep within who wants to get hunted because you were born you? And then say anyone deserves to feel that? I do not want to inspire anyone to violently act against the people who have so much fear inside themselves that they want to overtake the growing anxiety in them with growing urge to shed the (ever growing) anxiety under the carpet once again like so many times before this moment.

But hey! - Whatcha gonna do? Who're you gonna call? Ghostbusters won't help you here. This is not a ghost issue what you're going through. It's just denial. It's just your defence mechanisms at doing their best work. Driving their best season. Be proud of them! You succeeded in one thing in life at the least! Denial!

I'm not laughing at you. I'm laughing at myself. This is the thing I went through. This is my life. And I want to laugh with you. On me. On you. On life. On everything.

Arbeit macht frei' is'n richtijer Mist. Lachen macht frei. Humor macht frei. Weiss du?

Work sets you free is a crappy one-liner. Laughter sets you free. Humour sets you free? You know?

An Afterthought

Screw you guys - I’m going home

NOTES FOR SELF ONLY

Piss off

Miesten ongelmista
Mitä on olla mies
Mitä on haudata kaikki se raivo, mikä meissä on
Mikä meihin on haudattu liian nopean evoluution takia. Meidän ei tarvitse enää olla metsästäjätappajia, joten mitä me olemme? Siitä johtuu avioerot. Siitä johtuu monet sodat.